

Is the Web healthy?

How would we know?

Commons lens

- Resources: websites + visitors
- Infrastructure: Browsers + Search/LLMs + Internet (hosts, CDNs, DNS, etc)
- Are they being “provisioned” sufficiently?
- Are they being “appropriated” appropriately?
- If not: can we set up [Ostrom’s design principles](#)?

Signs of illness

- AI scraping is expensive for sites: <https://lwn.net/Articles/1008897/>
- AI summaries take traffic: [8% for Wikipedia](#)
- Small businesses often build FB/Instagram pages instead of websites
- Too many ads; intrusive data collection
- open-web-advocacy.org — barriers to building web apps
- [75% of users on Chromium](#) to which [94% of commits by Googlers](#)
- Not all people can see all sites (via fragmentation and age verification)
- Credibility
-

Loss of traffic/revenue/support

Measurement

- Private inside search engines
- Site complaints
- Measure from the ad industry?
-

Actions

- Payments from AI summarizers (with regulators?)
- MCP-UI (to give sites some control of their embeddings)
- Browser-integrated subscriptions
-

Scraping costs

Measurement

- [DoS protectors report](#) (14:1->73k:1)
- General buzz
-

Actions

- IETF AIPref
- Regulation ([EU](#)) + fines?
- Private+Open source DoS protection: Cloudflare+ReCaptcha+Anubis
- Poison — e.g. <https://zadzmo.org/code/nepenthes/>
-

Cost/difficulty of building sites

Measurement

- Total # of sites
- Count # of “good” sites
- Fraction of businesses with a website
- Fraction of individuals with a website

Action

- AI builders make authoring easier
- Standardize DNS+hosting?
- Integrate with browsers?
- W3C-provided website builder?
- Funded websites for small businesses?
- Education?
- <https://soloist.ai/>
- Do developer research
- <https://dokie.li/>

Exploited users

Measurement

- Avg fraction of page covered by ads?
- Fraction of sites with cookie banner?
- Sites redirecting users to an app
- Infinite scroll, draining users' attention
- Distinguish “harmful” cookies?
- Permission “quality”?
- Malware frequency?
-

Action

- Ad blockers
- Regulation
- GPC (and friends?)
- Education on privacy
- Well-being tools
- Describe deceptive patterns
- How much do we need to specify UI for this?

Browser concentration

Measurement

- Usage share
 - Divided by OS?
- Reports of contributor fractions
- Contributions to standards
- Influence over standards direction
- WPT pass rate of Servo+Ladybird+etc
 - Proportion of Baseline?
-

Action

- Find other browser funding sources than search deals?
 - Sovereign Tech Fund? (and similar)
 - <https://endowment.dev/>?
- Convince more users+sites to fund the commons directly?
- Make browser development easier?
-

Not all people can see all sites

Measurement

- measurement of internet shutdowns
 - ISOC, <https://netblocks.org/>, ...
- Jurisdictional boundaries
- Fraction of people who notionally the government wants to allow, who are excluded anyway
- Identify web standards which may be unintentionally excluding web users in certain contexts?

Actions

- Refine the actual goal (not all sites are worth allowing?)
- Give advice on how to regulate content w/o breaking the web?
- Finding on “region locking”
-

Credibility

Divergence in treatment of 3p cookies

Brainstorming

Metrics should have a connection to some action someone could take. (Not all current ones do.)

Metrics and actions can be directed at us or particular actors.